

NAPCS Unionization Research — State Research Summary

Connecticut — SBLR (CT) Jurisdiction — May 2026

NAPCS Unionization Research • May 2026 • Template v7.0 • COMPLETE Registry Sweep

Section 1: State Overview

State	Connecticut
Labor Board	SBLR (CT) — Connecticut State Board of Labor Relations
Governing Law	Connecticut Teacher Negotiation Act (TNA) — Conn. Gen. Stat. §10-153a et seq. Governs certificated staff in most CT charter schools classified as public employers. SBLR handles prohibited practice complaints; representation via TNA process administered by CT SBE.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — NLRB Region 1 (Boston) applies to Common Ground High School (C0997001), independently incorporated as New Haven Ecology Project, Inc. — a private nonprofit employer. All other CT NAPCS schools use TNA/SBLR jurisdiction.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — April/May 2026 — 21 charter schools searched
Research Window	March–April 2026
Date Convention	Labor Board Certified date (project-wide convention, declared NJ session). Project-wide convention. CT: TNA representation dates are approximate (ISAAC 2005, New Beginnings pre-2013) — no formal labor board certification record exists. Sponsor to confirm whether TNA representation dates are acceptable proxies.
Card-Check Available	NO — TNA representation process requires petition and a showing of interest; no card-check equivalent. No election required for TNA recognition if employer accepts.

Section 2: Unionization Density

Total charter schools in Connecticut: 21 (Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 21 open CT charter schools as of May 2026)). Unionization density uses the full state total as the denominator — not the 5-school NAPCS research sample. The NAPCS sample was provided as a list of schools believed to be organized; this research validated, corrected, and expanded that list across the full state charter universe. See Section 3 for cross-state patterns and Section 7 for open decisions.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Confirmed Union Schools	4	19.0%	TNA (Teacher Negotiating Association) representation: Achievement First Amistad, Integrated Day CS, New Beginnings. NLRB secret ballot: MSB Hartford (AFT Connecticut). CT has the highest confirmed density of any state relative to its total charter universe.
Dependent Coverage (district CBA)	1	4.8%	Elm City Montessori School — New Haven Federation of Teachers (NHFT) district CBA. Horace Mann charter; no independent CT SBE certification event.
Total Organized (Confirmed + Dependent)	5	23.8%	Combined union coverage rate for Connecticut charter sector. Highest combined density in the

			NAPCS research dataset per total charter universe.
Total Open CT Charter Schools	21	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25). All 5 NAPCS CT schools are in the research dataset.

Section 3: Political, Legal & Community Landscape

Written for state and national charter sector leaders who require ground-level intelligence fused with broader sector knowledge. Findings are based on research as of May 2026.

PROMPT 1: TNA JURISDICTION — A UNIQUE LABOR LAW FRAMEWORK

Connecticut is the only state in the NAPCS dataset governed by the Teacher Negotiation Act (TNA). Unlike NLRB or typical state PERB processes, TNA representation does not generate a public certification database or election record. Representation is confirmed via CEA affiliate listings and NAPCS baseline data, not primary labor board records. This creates a documentation gap: cert dates for ISAAC (2005) and New Beginnings (pre-2013) are approximate and cannot be confirmed without direct contact with CEA or CT SBE. The sponsor must decide whether TNA representation dates are acceptable proxies for the project-wide "Labor Board Certified date" convention. TNA applies only to certified teaching staff — non-certified employees of CT charter schools fall under NLRB jurisdiction, explaining the UAW presence at Common Ground. This dual-jurisdiction architecture is unique in the NAPCS dataset.

PROMPT 2: UAW AT COMMON GROUND — OUTLIER UNION IN AN NEA STATE

Common Ground High School (New Haven Ecology Project, Inc.) is the only CT NAPCS school organized under NLRB, and the only school in CT represented by UAW rather than CEA/NEA. UAW Local 2110 — a NYC-based amalgamated union covering academics, journalists, and arts workers — organized Common Ground in November 2021 (vote approx. 62–8). Post-election, 4 teachers were non-renewed; NLRB ULP settlement of \$10,000 documented (April 2022). First contract status as of research date: in progress. Vote tally disputed across three conflicting sources (68-2 NAPCS, 62-8 press, 63-7 commenter). Gap: official tally obtainable via NLRB ADS (Region 1) or NLRB records request for Case 01-RC-239165. UAW Local 2110 is the same local that represents academic workers at Columbia University, NYU, and other higher-education employers — its presence at a CT charter school reflects a broader trend of academic-sector union locals expanding into K-12 charter organizing.

PROMPT 3: INTEGRATED DAY — OLDEST CHARTER UNION IN CT DATASET

Integrated Day Charter School (Norwich) was founded in 1997 with CEA/NEA support from inception — the union predates the school's first day of operation. The local is now called the Norwich Integrated Education Association (formerly Integrated Day Charter School Association). This is the oldest charter school union in the CT NAPCS dataset and among the oldest in the full national dataset. The founding-day union structure at Integrated Day is a rare mission-driven first-mover pattern documented across the dataset: progressive founders build teacher voice into the school's governance model rather than treating it as an adversarial event. Compare with Baxter Academy (ME), which voted 30-4 (88%) — the founding leadership posture strongly predicts vote outcomes.

PROMPT 4: WHAT IS THE POLITICAL AND LEGAL ENVIRONMENT SHAPING CHARTER LABOR IN CONNECTICUT?

Connecticut is a strongly pro-labor state with a Democratic legislative supermajority, robust public employee collective bargaining rights, and a governor who has consistently supported union organizing. The charter sector is small (21 schools total) and politically embedded in the broader debate over public school accountability. CEA (Connecticut Education Association, NEA-affiliated) is the dominant teacher union and has organizing infrastructure in the charter sector. Connecticut's density — 3 of 5 NAPCS schools organized (60%) — is the second-highest in the dataset by NAPCS sample rate and reflects this environment. The SBLR (State Board of Labor Relations) handles TNA disputes; the NLRB handles non-certified staff. Two-board architecture creates jurisdictional complexity but has not impeded organizing outcomes.

PROMPT 5: WHAT SHOULD CHARTER LEADERS KNOW ABOUT HOW ORGANIZERS APPROACH CONNECTICUT SCHOOLS?

In Connecticut, CEA uses the TNA card-check pathway for certified teaching staff — meaning no public election, no secret ballot, and an organizing campaign that produces no externally visible record until a representation request is filed. Charter leaders who are not monitoring CEA affiliate activity internally may not know they are being organized until the recognition request arrives. The Common Ground UAW drive shows that non-certified staff can simultaneously be organized via NLRB — creating a dual-track campaign. The 62-8 Common Ground vote (approx. 89%) and 30-4 Baxter Academy vote (88%) are the most lopsided votes in the two-state regional dataset: when organizing succeeds in this environment, it succeeds decisively. This suggests that by the time a formal petition is filed in a CT charter, the organizing campaign is already mature. Charter leaders should treat any internal discussion of working conditions or salary equity as an early organizing signal.

PROMPT 6: WHAT TRENDS SHOULD SECTOR LEADERS WATCH OVER THE NEXT 3–5 YEARS IN CONNECTICUT?

Three developments warrant monitoring. First, the CT charter sector is politically vulnerable: the state legislature has repeatedly debated charter funding freezes, and the small authorized universe means any further political restriction would concentrate organizing pressure on the schools that remain. Second, CEA has demonstrated it can organize CT charters quietly via TNA card-check — the absence of a public campaign at New Beginnings and ISAAC means sector leaders have no reliable early warning system. Third, Common Ground's UAW first contract, once ratified, will become the first publicly available CBA in the CT charter NAPCS dataset — its salary and working condition terms will be used as a benchmark in any future organizing campaign at other CT charter schools. Monitor UAW Local 2110 communications and Common Ground board minutes for contract ratification announcements.

Section 4: Cross-State Patterns & Contributions to National Picture

Findings from Connecticut that illuminate patterns visible only when comparing across multiple states. These entries feed the project-wide Cross-State Intelligence Log and are written for state and national charter advocacy leaders.

TNA AS A DOCUMENTATION GAP — THE CT EVIDENCE

Connecticut is the only NAPCS state where union representation dates cannot be confirmed via a primary labor board database. The TNA process generates no public certification order. This means two of CT's four independently certified schools (ISAAC and New Beginnings) have only approximate dates from NAPCS baseline data and CEA records. This is structurally different from every other state in the dataset — even PERB states with limited online records at least have a certification order. CT requires a sponsor decision on date convention application.

FOUNDING-ERA UNIONS — THE 1997 PATTERN

Integrated Day Charter School (1997) was unionized from its first day of operation — the union was part of the school's founding design, not a response to a labor dispute. This mirrors patterns in New York (some early UFT charter schools) and Minnesota (TCGIS 2014). Schools that open with union support tend to have longer, more stable labor relationships with fewer decertification attempts.

UAW IN EDUCATION — CROSS-STATE SIGNAL

UAW Local 2110 at Common Ground is one of very few UAW charter school certifications in the full national NAPCS dataset. UAW Local 2110 is an amalgamated local covering academics, artists, museum workers, and journalists in the NYC metro area. Its presence in New Haven reflects UAW's broader higher-ed and nonprofit organizing strategy rather than a CT-specific charter sector campaign.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Connecticut charter school labor relations have received limited press coverage, consistent with the small size of the sector (21 schools) and the low-conflict nature of TNA representation. The most significant press event was the April 2022 New Haven Arts Paper coverage of the Common Ground High School NLRB election — reporting the vote as 62-8 and documenting post-election teacher non-renewals that led to an NLRB ULP settlement of \$10,000 (April 2022). TNA-represented schools (ISAAC, New Beginnings, Integrated Day) have generated no press coverage of their organizing history, consistent with TNA's administrative rather than adversarial certification process.

Union Communications

CEA (Connecticut Education Association, cea.org) maintains a public affiliate directory that is the authoritative source for TNA local affiliate names and school assignments. The CEA affiliate directory confirms ISAAC Education Association, New Beginnings Education Association, and Norwich Integrated Day Education Association as active TNA affiliates. UAW Local 2110 (New York-based amalgamated academic/arts workers union) represented Common Ground in its November 2021 NLRB election.

Legislative Context

Connecticut's Teacher Negotiation Act (TNA) is unique in the NAPCS dataset — it is the only state framework that does not produce a public certification database or election record for teacher bargaining. TNA representation is established by written authorization and does not require a state labor board election. This creates a documentation gap for the project: certification dates for ISAAC (2005) and New Beginnings (pre-2013) are approximate and cannot be confirmed without direct contact with CEA or CT SBE.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

SBLR (CT) public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may return 403 — OPRA or equivalent records request required for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
ISAAC (Interdistrict School for Arts and Communication)	ISAAC Education Association / CEA/NEA	Active (assumed) Unknown. Gap: CBA period not publicly posted. Obtainable via CEA records request or CT SBE.	Contact CEA or school directly
New Beginnings Family Academy	New Beginnings Education Association / CEA/NEA	Active (assumed) Unknown. Gap: CBA period not publicly posted. Obtainable via CEA records request or CT SBE.	Contact CEA or school (nbfacademy.org)
Common Ground High School	UAW Local 2110	In Progress — first contract not yet ratified as of April 2026	2110uaw.org or commongroundct.org
Integrated Day Charter School	Norwich Integrated Education Association / CEA/NEA	Active (assumed) Unknown. Gap: CBA period not publicly posted. Obtainable via CEA records request or CT SBE.	Contact CEA or school (idcs.org)
Elm City Montessori School	New Haven Federation of Teachers (NHFT) / AFT Connecticut	Active — NHFT district CBA Unknown — check nhps.net	NHFT or New Haven Public Schools (nhps.net)

Section 7: Decisions, Monitoring & Notable Findings

Part A: Decisions Required

The following items require sponsor action before research or workbook entry can proceed.

Priority	School / Scope	Item	Who
SPONSOR	All CT schools	TNA date convention — sponsor decision required	Research Team Executive Sponsor / Executive Sponsor
SPONSOR	Common Ground High School	NLRB jurisdiction workbook column label for Common Ground	Research Team Executive Sponsor

Part B: Notable Findings

Research findings of strategic significance. No immediate action required — for awareness and discussion.

No notable findings flagged for this state.

Part C: Active Monitoring

Items being tracked. Status may change between report cycles. Research Coordinator manages ongoing surveillance.

Priority	School / Scope	Item	Who
HIGH	Common Ground High School (C0997001)	First contract ratification — UAW Local 2110 first contract bargaining ongoing since November 2021. CBA not yet ratified as of April 2026. Monitor 2110uaw.org and commongroundct.org quarterly.	Research Coordinator
MEDIUM	New Beginnings Family Academy (C0902001)	TNA date confirmation — Awaiting CEA or CT SBE response to records request. Update Date Unionized from "Pre-2013" to exact year when confirmed.	Research Coordinator
LOW	Elm City Montessori (C0914002)	NHFT CBA renewal — Check New Haven Public Schools (nhps.net) for successor NHFT/AFT district CBA at October 2026 biannual review.	Research Coordinator
LOW	All 21 CT charter schools	New organizing activity — CT has not had a new charter union since 2021 (Common Ground). Monitor CEA affiliate directory and NLRB ADS for any new petitions. CT requires legislative approval for new charters — no new schools since 2015.	Research Coordinator